PROJECT REPORT

DIGITAL LITERACY

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Introduction

In today's world, digital technology has become an essential part of our daily lives, especially for students. From learning and communication to collaboration and career development, digital tools play a major role in shaping how we interact with information and with others. This project was designed to help develop a deeper understanding of digital literacy and its practical applications.

As a Student Digital Ambassador, the aim of this project was to explore different aspects of the digital world, including creating visual content, building a professional online presence, using learning platforms, practicing effective communication, and understanding cyber safety. Each task in this project provided hands-on experience with tools and concepts that are important for both academic and professional growth.

Through this project, I was able to not only learn about digital tools but also apply them in real-life scenarios. It helped me become more aware of how to use technology responsibly, communicate effectively, and build a strong digital identity.

Task 1: Infographic

The first task involved creating a digital literacy infographic using Canva, titled "The Digital Creator's Toolkit." In this infographic, I focused on explaining what digital literacy means and why it is important. I also included topics like safe internet practices, email etiquette, and commonly used digital tools for students. Since I am interested in computer science and media, I tried to include tools related to programming as well as content creation to make the infographic more relevant to my interests.

While working on the design, I found it a bit challenging to organize all the information properly without making the infographic look crowded. At first, everything felt too packed, but gradually I learned how to use spacing, icons, and Canva's layout features to make it look clean and readable. This process helped me understand how important visual structure is when presenting information.

Overall, this task improved my creativity and presentation skills. It also made me realize that visual content can communicate ideas much more effectively than plain text, especially when explaining concepts like digital literacy.

Task 2: Digital Portfolio

In this task, I created my digital portfolio by setting up and updating profiles on platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms helped me build a basic professional identity online where I could showcase my background, skills, and interests.

On GitHub, I started building my profile where I can upload projects and track my learning progress over time. LinkedIn helped me understand how professional networking works and how students can connect with others in their field. Kaggle introduced me to the world of data science and gave me an idea of how real-world datasets are used for analysis and learning.

Working on this task made me realize how important it is to maintain a professional online presence from the beginning of college itself. It felt like I was taking my first step toward building a career profile. I also understood that these platforms are not just for assignments but can actually help me grow academically and professionally in the long run.

Task 3: Exploring Digital Platforms

This task was focused on exploring platforms used for coding and collaboration. I used HackerRank to practice programming and improve my problem-solving skills. Through regular practice, I was able to earn multiple certificates and achieve a 5-star rating in Python, which gave me confidence in my learning progress.

Along with that, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. I included both multiple-choice and short-answer questions to make it interactive. The responses were automatically stored in Google Sheets, which made it easy to organize and analyse the data.

This task helped me understand how different digital tools can be used not just for learning but also for collaboration and data collection. It showed me how platforms like HackerRank can improve coding skills, while tools like Google Forms can be used for surveys, quizzes, and academic work.

Task 4: Email Etiquette and Communication

In this task, I worked on improving my professional communication skills. I wrote two formal emails, one requesting an extension for an assignment and another expressing interest in a summer internship. I also created a checklist of social media do's and don'ts to understand responsible online behaviour.

One important thing I learned from this task is how small communication mistakes can lead to bigger problems. For example, in a group project, if someone updates shared work without informing others, it can cause confusion or even loss of data. This made me realize how important it is to communicate clearly and keep everyone informed while working in a team.

This task helped me become more aware of how to communicate properly in academic and professional settings. It also made me understand that our behaviour online directly affects how others perceive us.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness

In this task, I studied cybercrime with a focus on UPI and online payment fraud. I learned how scammers often trick people into sharing sensitive information like OTPs or PINs by creating a sense of urgency or trust. What surprised me the most was that many of these scams do not involve advanced hacking but instead rely on manipulating people psychologically.

This made me realize that being aware and cautious is just as important as having technical knowledge. Even people who are familiar with technology can become victims if they are not careful.

After learning about these risks, I have decided to be more careful while making online transactions. I will always verify requests before taking any action and avoid clicking on unknown links. This task increased my awareness of online safety and encouraged me to follow better digital practices in my daily life.

Tools Used

- Canva – for designing infographic
- GitHub – for project hosting
- LinkedIn – for professional networking
- Kaggle – for data science exploration
- HackerRank – for coding practice
- Google Forms – for quiz creation

Key Learnings

- Gained a clear understanding of digital literacy and its importance
- Learned safe internet practices and cybersecurity awareness
- Developed professional communication skills
- Improved problem-solving and coding abilities
- Understood the importance of maintaining a digital portfolio
- Explored digital platforms for learning and interaction

Conclusion

Overall, this project was a valuable learning experience that helped me understand the importance of digital literacy in today's fast-paced world. Each task contributed to improving different skills, ranging from creativity and technical knowledge to communication and awareness about online safety.

I learned how to present information visually, build a professional online profile, use platforms for learning and collaboration, and communicate effectively in formal settings. The cybercrime awareness task was particularly impactful, as it highlighted the importance of being cautious and responsible while using digital platforms.

This project has encouraged me to continue developing my skills and to use digital tools more effectively in my academic journey. It has also helped me take the first step toward building a strong and responsible digital presence, which will be useful for my future career.

References

- Canva – Used for creating the digital literacy infographic
- GitHub – Used for building and managing the project repository and profile
- LinkedIn – Used for creating a professional profile
- Kaggle – Used for exploring data science concepts and datasets
- HackerRank – Used for practicing programming and improving problem-solving skills
- Google Forms – Used to create a digital literacy awareness quiz
- Google Sheets – Used to collect and analyse quiz responses
- National Cyber Crime Portal – https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline – 1930